

# Word family: **sense / senses / sensed / sensing / sensible / sensibly / senseless / senselessly**

**Base word:** sense

**Plural:** senses

**Past tense:** sensed

**Past participle:** sensed

**-ing form:** sensing

**Useful related forms:** sensible, sensibly, senseless, senselessly

**Part of speech:** noun ( 名詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 )

Your sentence:

> “He never tried to show off, and he had a great **sense of humour**, so even an ordinary day felt lighter when he was around.”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, **sense** appears in the fixed construction **a sense of humour**.

A **sense of humour** is a person's **ability to recognize, appreciate, and create things that are funny**.

**繁體中文：** **理解、欣賞並產生幽默的能力；幽默感**

**中文翻譯：**

> “...he had a great **sense of humour**...”

「.....而且他很有**幽默感**.....」

Here:

**a great sense of humour = 很能欣賞及表現幽默；很有幽默感**

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# 1. **sense = physical ability to perceive ( 感官 ) — 感官；感覺能力**

**Meaning:** One of the physical abilities through which people or animals receive information about the world.

Traditionally these include sight, hearing, smell, taste, and touch.

### Practice 1

> “Dogs have a very strong **sense** of smell.”

「狗有非常靈敏的\*\*嗅覺\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “His \*\*sense\*\* of taste gradually returned.”

「他的\*\*味覺\*\*逐漸恢復了。」

**\*\*sense = 身體接收外界刺激並產生知覺的感官能力\*\***

Common:

- \* sense of smell
- \* sense of taste
- \* sense of touch
- \* the five senses

This is the basic physical-perception sense.

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# 2. **\*\*sense = awareness / intuitive feeling ( 感覺 / 察覺 ) — 感覺 ; 意識 ; 察覺\*\***

**\*\*Sense\*\*** can mean an awareness or feeling that something exists, is happening, or is likely to happen, even without direct proof.

#### ### Practice 3

> “I had a strange \*\*sense\*\* that something was wrong.”

「我有一種奇怪的\*\*感覺\*\*，覺得有些事情不對勁。」

#### ### Practice 4

> “There was a strong \*\*sense\*\* of excitement in the room.”

「房間裡有一種強烈的\*\*興奮氣氛 / 感覺\*\*。」

**\*\*sense = 對某種情況、情緒或可能發生的事情所產生的感覺或意識\*\***

Common:

- \* sense of danger
- \* sense of excitement
- \* sense of relief

\* sense of belonging

This is broader and more abstract than the five physical senses.

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# 3. \*\*sense of + ability/quality ( 能力 / 判斷 ) — .....感 ; 對.....的理解能力\*\*

This is the meaning family used in your passage.

\*\*Sense of\*\* can refer to a person's ability to understand, appreciate, judge, or respond appropriately in a particular area.

### Practice 5 — Original

> “He had a great \*\*sense of humour\*\*.”

「他很有\*\*幽默感\*\*。」

### Practice 6

> “She has an excellent \*\*sense of direction\*\*.”

「她有很強的\*\*方向感\*\*。」

### Practice 7

> “He has a strong \*\*sense of responsibility\*\*.”

「他有很強的\*\*責任感\*\*。」

\*\*sense of X = 對某方面具有理解、判斷、欣賞或意識的能力\*\*

Common:

\* sense of humour → 幽默感

\* sense of direction → 方向感

\* sense of responsibility → 責任感

\* sense of rhythm → 節奏感

\* sense of proportion → 分寸感 / 比例感

These Chinese translations vary, but the underlying English idea is often:

> \*\*an internal awareness or ability relating to a particular area\*\*

So I would not split each phrase into a new meaning.

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# 4. **sense** = good judgment / practical wisdom ( 判斷力 ) — 判斷力；理智；常識

**Sense** can mean the ability to make reasonable and practical decisions.

#### Practice 8

> “Use your **sense** and think before you act.”

「用點**理智 / 判斷力**，行動前先想清楚。」

#### Practice 9

> “She had enough **sense** to ask for help.”

「她有足夠的**判斷力 / 常識**，知道要尋求幫助。」

**sense** = 作出合理、實際判斷的能力

This appears very commonly in:

> **common sense**

= **常識；基本判斷力**

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# 5. **sense** = meaning of a word/expression ( 語義 ) — 意義；義項

This is an important language/academic meaning.

#### Practice 10

> “The word has several different **senses**.”

「這個詞有幾個不同的**義項 / 意思**。」

#### Practice 11

> “In this **sense**, the word refers to physical movement.”

「在這個**意義 / 用法**中，這個詞指的是身體移動。」

**sense** = 一個詞、句子或表達方式在某個語境中的特定意義

This is especially relevant to your polysemy project:

> one word → several senses

It is close to **meaning**, but **sense** is often more technical and refers to **one particular semantic interpretation of a word**.

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# 6. **sense** = intelligibility / logic ( 道理 / 可理解性 ) — 道理 ; 合理性

This appears especially in **make sense**.

### Practice 12

> “Your explanation makes **sense**.”

「你的解釋**很有道理 / 說得通**。」

### Practice 13

> “It doesn’t make **sense** to leave so early.”

「這麼早離開**沒有道理 / 不合理**。」

**make sense** = 在邏輯上合理、能夠理解或說得通

This is not simply “meaning.” It concerns whether something is coherent or reasonable.

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# 7. **sense** = aspect / respect / way of looking at something ( 角度 ) — 意義上 ; 層面 ; 角度

In expressions such as **in one sense / in a sense**, **sense** can mean a particular way of understanding or viewing a situation.

### Practice 14

> “In one **sense**, the two ideas are quite similar.”

「從某個**角度 / 層面**來說，這兩個想法很相似。」

### Practice 15

> “In a **sense**, we were all beginners.”

「從某種\*\*意義 / 角度\*\*來說，我們當時都是初學者。」

\*\*in a/one sense = 從某個理解方式、層面或角度來看\*\*

This develops from the \*\*meaning/interpretation\*\* sense and can usually be grouped with it for strict counting.

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# 8. \*\*sense = perceive / become aware of ( 動詞 ) — 感覺到；察覺到\*\*

As a verb, \*\*sense\*\* means to become aware of something, often indirectly or intuitively.

### Practice 16

> “She \*\*sensed\*\* that he was nervous.”

「她\*\*察覺到\*\*他很緊張。」

### Practice 17

> “I could \*\*sense\*\* tension in the room.”

「我能\*\*感覺到\*\*房間裡的緊張氣氛。」

\*\*sense something = 透過感官、直覺或細微線索察覺到某件事情\*\*

This is the main verb meaning.

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# 9. \*\*sense = detect by a device/system ( 科技 ) — 感測；偵測\*\*

Machines and electronic systems can also \*\*sense\*\* conditions.

### Practice 18

> “The device \*\*senses\*\* changes in temperature.”

「這個裝置會\*\*感測 / 偵測\*\*溫度變化。」

### Practice 19

> “The lights turn on when the system \*\*senses\*\* movement.”

「系統\*\*偵測到\*\*移動時，燈便會亮起。」

**\*\*sense = 由感測器或系統偵測物理變化或訊號\*\***

For core counting, I would merge this with the broader verb meaning:

> **\*\*detect/perceive\*\***

The subject changes from a person to a machine, but the core concept remains detection.

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# Related form: **\*\*sensible\*\***

**\*\*Sensible\*\*** means practical, reasonable, and showing good judgment.

#### Practice 20

> “That sounds like a **\*\*sensible\*\*** solution.”

「那聽起來是一個**\*\*合理實際\*\***的解決方法。」

#### Practice 21

> “Wear **\*\*sensible\*\*** shoes for the hike.”

「遠足時要穿**\*\*實用合適\*\***的鞋。」

**\*\*sensible = 合理、實際並顯示良好判斷力的\*\***

This develops from the **\*\*good judgment\*\*** branch of **\*\*sense\*\***.

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# Related form: **\*\*sensibly\*\***

#### Practice 22

> “She dealt with the problem **\*\*sensibly\*\***.”

「她很**\*\*理智 / 合理地\*\***處理了問題。」

**\*\*sensibly = 以合理、實際、有判斷力的方式\*\***

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# Related form: **senseless**

**Senseless** has two particularly useful meanings.

## **senseless** = without purpose/reason ( 毫無意義的 )

### Practice 23

> “It was a **senseless** act of destruction.”

「那是一種**毫無意義 / 毫無理性的破壞行為**。」

**senseless** = 沒有合理目的、理由或意義的

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## **senseless** = unconscious ( 失去知覺的 )

### Practice 24

> “The impact knocked him **senseless**.”

「那次撞擊令他**失去知覺**。」

**senseless** = 暫時失去意識或知覺的

These are related historically but distinct enough to show explicitly.

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# Important distinction: **sense** vs **feeling**

### **feeling**

is very broad and can refer to:

- \* emotion
- \* physical sensation
- \* opinion
- \* intuition

### **sense**

often emphasizes:

- \* awareness

- \* perception
- \* ability to detect or understand something

Compare:

> “a feeling of sadness”

= 悲傷的情緒

> “a sense of danger”

= 察覺到危險的感覺

There is overlap, but **sense** often sounds more like awareness than emotion itself.

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# Important distinction: **sense** vs **meaning**

This is especially important for your database.

### **meaning**

is the broad idea or message expressed by a word, sentence, action, etc.

### **sense**

in linguistics can refer to one **particular interpretation or semantic use** of a word.

For example:

> “bank has several senses.”

Each distinct lexical interpretation can be called a **sense**.

So:

**meaning** = 意思 / 意義

**sense** = 某個具體義項 / 語義用法

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# Important distinction: **sense** vs **common sense**

### **sense**

can broadly mean good judgment.

### \*\*common sense\*\*

specifically means ordinary practical judgment that most reasonable people are expected to have.

> “Use some common sense.”

= 「用點常識 / 基本判斷力。」

This is a fixed combination rather than a new lexical meaning.

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# Important distinction: \*\*sense vs sensible\*\*

This is a common learner trap.

### \*\*sense\*\*

noun/verb:

> “He has good sense.”

> “I sensed a problem.”

### \*\*sensible\*\*

adjective:

> “That is a sensible choice.”

So:

\*\*sense = 感覺 / 判斷力 / 意義\*\*

\*\*sensible = 合理實際、有判斷力的\*\*

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# Important distinction: \*\*sensible vs sensitive\*\*

These are often confused.

### \*\*sensible\*\*

= practical and reasonable

> a sensible decision

> 合理的決定

### \*\*sensitive\*\*

= easily affected by feelings, physical stimuli, or small changes

> sensitive skin

> 敏感肌膚

> a sensitive person

> 敏感的人

They are related historically but are **not interchangeable** in modern English.

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# Fixed expression: **make sense** — 說得通；有道理

### Practice 25

> “That explanation makes **sense**.”

「那個解釋**說得通**。」

### Practice 26

> “His decision didn’t make much **sense** to me.”

「他的決定在我看來不太**合理 / 說不通**。」

**make sense** = 合乎邏輯、合理或容易理解

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# Fixed expression: **make sense of something** — 弄懂；理解

This is slightly different.

### Practice 27

> “I’m trying to **make sense of** these results.”

「我正在嘗試\*\*弄明白 / 理解\*\*這些結果。」

#### ### Practice 28

> “She could not \*\*make sense of\*\* his message.”

「她無法\*\*理解\*\*他的訊息。」

\*\*make sense of something = 理解原本混亂、複雜或不清楚的事情\*\*

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# Fixed expression: \*\*come to your senses — 恢復理智\*\*

#### ### Practice 29

> “He eventually \*\*came to his senses\*\* and apologized.”

「他最後\*\*恢復理智 / 醒悟過來\*\*並道歉。」

\*\*come to your senses = 恢復清醒、理智或正常判斷\*\*

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# Fixed expression: \*\*lose your senses — 失去知覺 / 失去理智\*\*

Depending on context, this can mean losing consciousness or rational judgment.

#### ### Practice 30

> “For a moment, he seemed to have \*\*lost his senses\*\*.”

「有一瞬間，他似乎\*\*失去了理智 / 知覺\*\*。」

This is related to the perception/judgment branches.

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# Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

\* \*\*sense\*\*

\* \*\*senses\*\*

\* \*\*sensed\*\*

\* \*\*sensing\*\*

\* \*\*sensible\*\*  
 \* \*\*sensibly\*\*  
 \* \*\*senseless\*\*  
 \* \*\*senselessly\*\*

Useful constructions include:

\* sense of humour  
 \* sense of direction  
 \* sense of responsibility  
 \* sense of smell  
 \* common sense  
 \* make sense  
 \* make sense of  
 \* in a sense  
 \* come to your senses

Forms such as \*\*sensitive / sensitivity\*\* are historically related but have developed far enough semantically that I would normally treat them as a separate learner entry rather than pack them mechanically into \*\*sense\*\*.

That follows the Golden Manual's instruction to sweep families broadly but label lexical relatives accurately and avoid forcing semantically independent forms into one entry.

# Master comparison

| Form / sense                           | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                                  | -----                                 |
| **sense — physical perception**        | 身體接收外界刺激並形成知覺的感官能力                    |
| **sense — awareness/feeling**          | 對某種情況、情緒或可能存在的事情所產生的感覺或察覺             |
|                                        |                                       |
| **sense of X — ability/awareness**     | 對某方面具有理解、判斷、欣賞或意識的能力，如幽默感、方向感         |
|                                        |                                       |
| **sense — judgment**                   | 作出合理、實際決定的判斷能力；理智 / 常識                |
| **sense — lexical meaning**            | 一個詞或表達方式在某個語境中的特定義項或語義                |
|                                        |                                       |
| **make sense — logic/intelligibility** | 在邏輯上合理、容易理解或說得通                       |
| **in a sense**                         | 從某種理解方式、意義或角度來看；與 interpretation 義相關  |
| **sense — verb**                       | 透過感官、直覺、線索或設備察覺 / 偵測某事物               |
| **sensible**                           | 合理、實際並顯示良好判斷力的                        |
| **senseless**                          | 毫無道理 / 意義的；或失去知覺的                     |

# For your original sentence

> "...he had a great \*\*sense of humour\*\*..."

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*sense of humour = 理解、欣賞並表現幽默的能力\*\***

So:

> **\*\*have a great sense of humour\*\***

= **\*\*很有幽默感\*\***

It does **\*\*not\*\*** mean one of the five physical senses. Here **\*\*sense\*\*** refers to an internal **\*\*ability** to recognize and appreciate a particular quality**\*\***.

For your database, I would count **\*\*6 genuinely useful core meanings\*\*** for **\*\*sense\*\***:

1. **\*\*physical faculty of perception — one of the senses\*\***
2. **\*\*awareness / intuitive feeling of something\*\***
3. **\*\*ability or awareness in a particular area — sense of humour/direction\*\***
4. **\*\*good judgment / practical wisdom\*\***
5. **\*\*a particular meaning or interpretation\*\***
6. **\*\*verb — perceive, detect, or become aware of something\*\***

I would treat **\*\*make sense\*\*** as a major fixed construction connected to meaning/logic, merge technological **\*\*sensing\*\*** into #6, and keep **\*\*sensible, senseless\*\***, and similar forms as family extensions rather than inflate the bare-word count.